SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #4 · GOD

“God is too distant or too busy to care about me.”

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Where it often comes from

A parent who was absent, emotionally distant, or too busy to notice you. Growing up feeling that your needs were a bother. Prayers that seemed to go unanswered during a painful time. Teaching that pictured God as far off and unapproachable. Seasons of loneliness or depression, when God felt silent.

What Scripture teaches

God is not too busy for you. He knows when a sparrow falls, and He has numbered the hairs on your head. He is close to the brokenhearted, and He invites you to bring every worry to Him because He cares for you. There is nowhere you can go that is outside His presence. Not feeling close to God does not mean He has moved away.

> *“Cast all your anxiety on him because he cares for you”* **(1 Peter 5:7)**.

Also see

> “The LORD is close to the brokenhearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit” **(Psalm 34:18)**.

> “Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground outside your Father’s care. And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So don’t be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows” **(Matthew 10:29–31)**.

> “Where can I go from your Spirit? Where can I flee from your presence?” **(Psalm 139:7)**.

> “He will not let your foot slip—he who watches over you will not slumber; indeed, he who watches over Israel will neither slumber nor sleep” **(Psalm 121:3–4)**.

> “Never will I leave you; never will I forsake you” **(Hebrews 13:5)**.

Common self-statements

- God has bigger things to worry about than me.
- My problems are too small for God to care about.
- God is far away.
- I pray, but nobody is listening.
- God takes care of other people, but not me.
- I’m on my own.

Common logical errors

- **Emotional reasoning:** Concluding “I don’t feel God near me, so He must be far away.”
- **Projection:** Picturing God as distant and busy like a parent who had no time for you.
- **Minimization:** Deciding your needs are too small to matter to God.
- **Mental filter:** Remembering the prayers that seemed unanswered and forgetting the times God provided.
- **Jumping to conclusions:** Treating God’s timing or silence as proof that He does not care.
- **Overgeneralization:** Taking one lonely season as proof that God has always been, and will always be, distant.

Challenging questions

- What is the actual evidence that God does not care about me?
- Am I judging God's nearness by my feelings instead of by His promises?
- Who in my life was too busy for me? Am I picturing God like that person?
- If God keeps track of sparrows and the hairs on my head, is any worry of mine too small for Him?
- Have I forgotten times when God did provide, comfort, or protect me?
- Does Scripture say God is close to the brokenhearted, or far from them?

Truth summary

> God is not too distant or too busy to care about me. He watches over me without sleeping, He knows every detail of my life, and He is close to me when I am brokenhearted. He invites me to bring all my worries to Him because He cares for me. Even when I cannot feel Him, He has promised never to leave me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- God, Present Everywhere
- God, All Knowing
- Love, By God
- Loneliness
- Prayer, Answers To
- Refuge/Safety

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Prayer
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "God is too distant or too busy to care about me"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"God is too distant or too busy to care about me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What is the actual evidence that God does not care about me?
- ☐ Am I judging God's nearness by my feelings or by His promises?
- ☐ Am I picturing God like someone who was too busy for me?
- ☐ If God numbers the hairs on my head, is any worry too small?
- ☐ Have I forgotten times God provided for me?
- ☐ Does Scripture say God is near the brokenhearted, or far from them?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God cares for me, and I can bring Him every worry.
- ☐ God is close to me when I am brokenhearted.
- ☐ No concern of mine is too small for God.
- ☐ God never sleeps; He is always watching over me.
- ☐ Even when I cannot feel Him, God has not left me.
- ☐ I am worth more to God than many sparrows.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **1 Peter 5:7**
  "Cast all your anxiety on him because he cares for you."
- [ ] **Psalm 34:18**
  "The LORD is close to the brokenhearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit."
- [ ] **Matthew 10:29–31**
  "Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground outside your Father's care. And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So don't be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows."
- [ ] **Psalm 139:7**
  "Where can I go from your Spirit? Where can I flee from your presence?"
- [ ] **Psalm 121:3–4**
  "He will not let your foot slip—he who watches over you will not slumber; indeed, he who watches over Israel will neither slumber nor sleep."
- [ ] **Hebrews 13:5**
  "Never will I leave you; never will I forsake you."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Evidence log:** Each day, write down one way God cared for me or provided for me today.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 1 Peter 5:7 becomes: "**Sarah**, cast all your anxiety on him because he cares for **you**."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "God, Present Everywhere" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Bring one "small" worry to God** in prayer each day for a week, and write down what happens.
- ☐ **Make a "remember" list** of five times in your life when God provided, protected, or comforted you.
- ☐ **Reach out to one safe person** and share a need, instead of assuming you are a bother.
- ☐ **Live "as if" for one day:** act the way a person who believes God is near and cares would act.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "God is too distant or too busy to care about me": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A way God cared for me today
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~God is too distant or too busy to care about me.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, help me reject the lie that You are too distant or too busy to care about me. Thank You that You are close to the brokenhearted and that You watch over me without sleeping. Help me bring every worry to You, trusting that You care for me, even when I cannot feel You near. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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